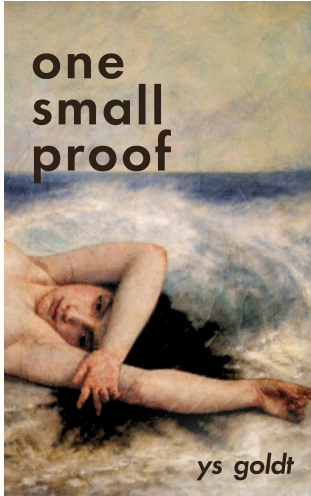




LITERARY SHORT STORY

One Small Proof

Sometimes the smallest proof of love is the thing that survives.

AUTHOR

Ys Goldt

PUBLICATION DATE

November 6, 2026

FORMATS

Paperback, ebook & PDF
32 pages

PUBLISHER

Nachtljocht Press

ISBN

9798996205240

SETTING

Southwest Florida coast –
present-day Naples

Literary Short Story

Grief & Tenderness

Coastal Fiction

Bittersweet Fiction

ABOUT THE BOOK

After loss leaves Taloa alone at the edge of her village, the ocean becomes the one place that asks nothing of her. Then, one morning, it gives something back: a wounded stranger washed ashore, speaking a language she cannot understand.

For a few brief days, Taloa and Tomás build something between them without shared words - through names, gestures, touch, and the simple act of being seen. But some encounters are never meant to last. Some leave behind only the smallest proof that they happened at all.

One Small Proof is a bittersweet literary short story about grief, tenderness, loneliness, and the quiet traces love leaves behind.

ABOUT YS GOLDT

Ys Goldt is a Southwest Florida writer and multidisciplinary artist working across literary and speculative fiction, fantasy, romance, interactive media and design. Her fiction frequently explores love, memory, identity, solitude and the quiet ways people alter one another. Whether writing historical settings or invented worlds, her work begins with character and returns to a central question: what does it cost to truly let another person in?

SOUTHWEST FLORIDA CONNECTION

Set along the coast of what is now Naples, Florida, One Small Proof draws on Goldt's childhood memories of visiting the Gulf with her father. After his death, those memories became intertwined with the story's exploration of grief, absence, and the way places continue to hold the people we have lost.

The village, characters, and events are fictional and are not intended to represent a specific historical Indigenous culture.

FOR READERS WHO ENJOY

Quiet literary fiction; bittersweet stories; grief and healing; wordless intimacy; coastal settings; emotionally restrained prose; and brief encounters with lasting consequences.

THEMES & INTERVIEW ANGLES

- Southwest Florida landscape and memory
- Writing the Gulf coast as emotional geography
- Returning to Naples through fiction
- Grief and the rituals of solitude
- Connection beyond shared language

CONTENT

Themes of bereavement, loneliness and injury, with bittersweet emotional material.

REVIEW, INTERVIEW & MEDIA ENQUIRIES

Please use the official press contact form at:

ysgoldt.com/press.html#press-contact

Complimentary digital and physical review copies are available to reviewers, creators and media upon request.